



OUTLIERS

Today

Layer 7 of 8 · One short list each morning.
Who, and why.

FOR MAC

EST. MMXXVI · OUTLIERS ACCELERATOR

What runs out is attention

You can keep thousands of records and still only speak to a handful of people in a day. That handful is the real limit on the whole system, and it is usually smaller than people plan for.

WHAT THE LAST LAYER LEFT YOU WITH

Your system is safe and orderly and full of useful information. It works through its queue in the order the queue was built, which means something that happened this morning sits behind whatever was already in there.

WHAT THIS LAYER BUILDS

One page, each morning. A short list of people, in the order they actually deserve your attention, with the reason on every line.

EVERYTHING THAT HAPPENED

someone replied this morning
a contact changed jobs
somebody liked a post
a conversation went quiet
a call got booked
a contact is due a catch-up

ORDER

TODAY

1 Rowan - replied this morning
2 Mara - started a new job
3 Tobias - 30 days since you spoke

everything else stepped aside

by how quickly it goes stale

MANY SIGNALS IN. ONE SHORT LIST OUT.

How it works

Ordered by how quickly something goes stale, not by how important the person is.

SOME REASONS STOP BEING WORTH ACTING ON VERY QUICKLY

A reply is worth answering now. The same reply answered 3 days later is worth much less, and left much longer it is slightly embarrassing. A contact who changed jobs is worth a note straight away and nothing much a month later.

Other reasons do not decay at all. Someone you have been meaning to catch up with for a while will still be there tomorrow.

So your list is ordered by how fast each reason goes off. The person at the top is not more important than the person below them. Their reason for being there is going off faster.

EVERY LINE SAYS WHY

A list without reasons is a list you argue with, and then ignore. When each line says *replied this morning* or *30 days since you spoke*, you either act or you consciously decide not to, and both are fine. What you do not do is stare at it.

SOME PEOPLE NEVER APPEAR

Anyone on your do-not-contact list. Anyone marked personal, so friends and family are never in a list of people to work through. Anyone you have already decided is not a fit. The list is what to act on, and the fastest way to stop yourself opening it is to fill it with people you have already ruled out.

EVERYTHING ELSE STEPS ASIDE ON ITS OWN

Anything that does not earn a place today does not pile up waiting for you. It parks itself and comes back if something changes. That is what stops the list becoming another source of guilt, which is what happens to most to-do systems.

HOW LONG IT SHOULD BE

The installer asks how many people you can speak to in a day, and that is the length. If the list is longer than you can actually do, it stops being a plan and becomes a reminder that you are behind.

Before you start on a Mac

Everything in this guide is typed into **Terminal**, the Mac's window for typing commands instead of clicking. Press Command and Space together, type Terminal, and press Return.

This layer needs Python and git, which you set up for Layer 1 (its page "Before you start on a Mac"), and the layers before this one. It installs no add-ons, so it works with either Python a Mac may have.

HOW TO TYPE THE LINES

Where this guide shows several lines in a black box, type them one at a time: type the first, press Return, wait for it to finish and give you a fresh line, then type the next. The installer asks you questions. Each offers an answer in [square brackets]; press Return to take it, or type your own and press Return.

WHERE YOUR CRM IS

Layer 1 made your CRM at ~/CRM: a folder called CRM in your home folder (the folder with your name and the house picture in Finder's sidebar). If you chose another folder in Layer 1, put your own folder wherever a line in this guide says ~/CRM. The installer finds your CRM by itself either way.

Apple Silicon or Intel (the 2 kinds of chip a Mac can have; the Apple menu, then About This Mac, shows yours): the steps are the same on both, and both were tested.

Tried only on test Macs. Every step in this guide and in the instructions file of the layer's download was tried on test Macs (Macs GitHub rents out by the minute to run a script, not a person's own Mac, and not yours), never on a real Mac, except 1: the box asking to install the developer tools, which cannot appear on a test Mac. The last pages list every line and what happened to it.

Build it

3 lines, typed into Terminal. The last one asks you a few questions so what you get is yours, then does the work.

```
git clone https://github.com/OUTLIERS-ai/outliers-crm-07-today-mac
cd outliers-crm-07-today-mac
python3 install.py
```

This layer needs Layers 1 to 6. It reads your history and respects your do-not-contact list.

WHAT IT ASKS YOU, AND WHY

QUESTION	WHAT IT CHANGES
What time do you start work?	Used only to label the page, so it reads like yours. Nothing is scheduled and nothing starts by itself: you build the page with 1 line, shown on the next page.
How many people can you genuinely speak to in a day?	Be honest and be conservative. This sets the length of the list. A short list you get through is worth more than a full one you do not.

WHAT YOU END UP WITH

- One page, rebuilt from scratch each time you build it, ordered by how quickly each reason goes stale.
- A reason on every line.
- Everything not on it parked automatically, and nobody on your do-not-contact list ever appearing.

Now use it

The one that changes how a working day feels.

Tomorrow morning, open your list before you open your inbox. Work only from it until it is done.

Nothing builds the list for you while you are away, so build it first, each morning. In Terminal, go to your CRM and type the line after the `cd` line (if your CRM is not at `~/CRM`, put your own folder in the `cd` line). It prints the list and writes it into `Today.md` in your CRM, which you open in Obsidian:

```
cd ~/CRM
python3 _engine/today.py --write
```

Usually, 2 changes follow. You get through it faster than you expected, because deciding who to deal with is most of the work and that decision was already made. And you notice how much of your usual morning was spent reacting to whoever shouted loudest rather than to whatever was going off fastest.

IF YOU ALREADY HAD SOMETHING LIKE THIS

Your test: how do you currently decide who to contact first? If the honest answer is whoever is most recent in your inbox, that is your inbox setting your priorities, and your inbox does not know which of those messages goes stale fastest.

WHAT THIS LAYER LEAVES UNSOLVED

You are fast now, and working on assumptions. The order rests on a belief about which signals matter, and that belief has never been tested against what actually happens. There is also nothing telling you whether the system is still working, or quietly doing nothing at all.

NEXT: LAYER 8 • VERIFICATION

Counting what actually happened, from your own records, and a check that shouts when the system stops working.

WORDS USED IN THIS GUIDE

Perishable	Something that stops being worth doing if you leave it.
Parked	Set aside automatically, returning if something changes.
Signal	Something that happened which might be worth acting on.

What was run on a Mac

A **test Mac** is one of the Macs GitHub rents out by the minute to run a script.

Each line below is one this guide or the instructions file of the layer's download (README.md) gives you to type.

The run was on 2026-09-26. A script (a list of commands each test Mac carries out by itself) downloaded a fresh copy of the download from GitHub on each of 7 test Macs and ran each line below exactly as printed, in this order. After a `cd` line (`cd` moves Terminal into a folder), the lines that follow ran in that folder, as they do for you. The script ran them; no person typed them.

7 test runs: 3 on Macs set up from scratch (macOS 15.7.9 on Apple Silicon, macOS 15.7.9 on Intel, macOS 26.6.2 on Apple Silicon), and 4 on 2 Macs that also have Homebrew, an add-on installer many Mac owners use, each run once with Homebrew installed before Python and once after (macOS 15.7.9 on Apple Silicon and macOS 15.7.9 on Intel). Before the first line, the script put these on every Mac: Python from python.org; Layers 1 to 6 of the CRM, installed from their Mac downloads. GitHub's Macs already have Apple's developer tools, which include git.

EACH LINE, THEN WHAT HAPPENED TO IT

```
git clone https://github.com/OUTLIERS-ai/outliers-crm-07-today-mac
```

worked on all 7 test Macs

```
cd outliers-crm-07-today-mac
```

worked on all 7 test Macs

```
python3 install.py
```

worked on all 7 test Macs

```
cd ~/CRM
```

worked on all 7 test Macs

```
python3 _engine/today.py --write
```

worked on all 7 test Macs

```
cd ~/outliers-crm-07-today-mac
```

worked on all 7 test Macs

```
python3 tests/test_today.py
```

worked on all 7 test Macs

The script's record of the run is public, for anyone who wants to check it; you do not need to open it:

<https://github.com/OUTLIERS-ai/outliers-mac-test/actions/runs/36210572329>

NOT RUN ON THE TEST MACS

The box asking to install the developer tools cannot appear on a test Mac, because GitHub's Macs already have them.

Opening your CRM in Obsidian. The test Macs have no Obsidian; the script read the folders and files the installer made instead.